The Food-Mood Connection

Welcome to a new way of nourishing your mental wellness.

Autumn Persinger, PMHNP-BC | Real Psychiatric Services

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In This Introduction, We'll Explore

Why You're Here

Validating the common struggles that bring people to this topic.

The Big Idea

The simple but powerful truth about how food builds your brain.

A Different Approach

How this course differs from typical "diet" advice.

Your First Step

Setting a personal intention for your journey.

Does This Sound Familiar?

Afternoon Energy Crash

That 3 PM slump that hits like a ton of bricks.

Persistent Brain Fog

Difficulty focusing in meetings or on important tasks.

Stress-Induced Cravings

Reaching for sugary or salty foods when anxious.

Nutrition Confusion

Feeling overwhelmed by conflicting advice about what works.

If you nodded yes to any of these, you're in exactly the right place.

The Single Most Important Idea

What You Eat

Your daily food choices.

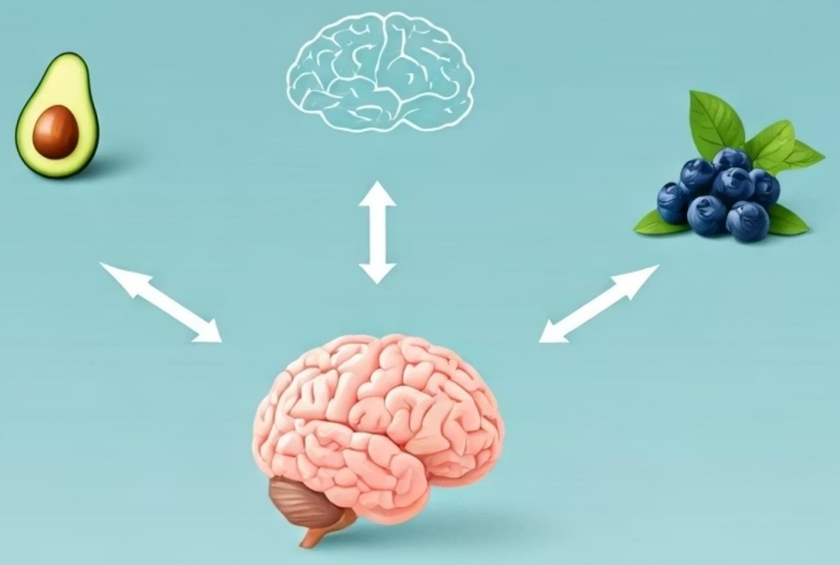
Becomes

Direct biological conversion.

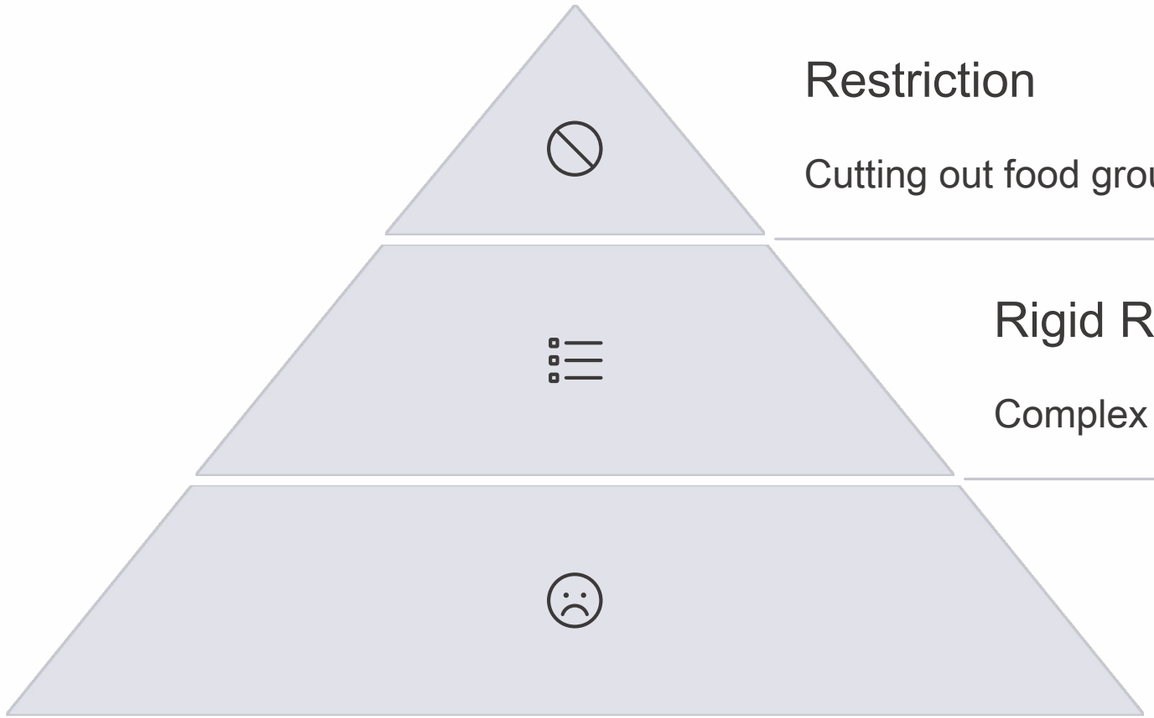
Your Brain

Building blocks for neurotransmitters.

Your brain isn't separate from your body. It's built and fueled by the food you eat.



We're Drowning in Advice... and Shame



Restriction

Cutting out food groups

Rigid Rules

Complex do's and don'ts

Shame Cycle

Feeling like a failure

Most nutritional advice is built on restriction and rules. This cycle increases anxiety and creates a stressful relationship with food.

This Course is a "No-Shame Zone"

Nourishment over Restriction

We focus on what we can add to support our brain, not what to eliminate.

Curiosity over Judgment

We learn from our body's signals rather than criticizing ourselves.

Progress over Perfection

Every small, mindful choice is celebrated as a meaningful win.

True, lasting change comes from kindness and understanding, not harsh rules.

A Story from My Practice

The Client

A busy professional with persistent afternoon anxiety.

The Discovery

Through journaling, we identified a blood sugar crash pattern.

The Solution

Adding more protein and fiber to lunch dramatically improved symptoms.

The Insight

It wasn't a personal failing—it was a biological signal.

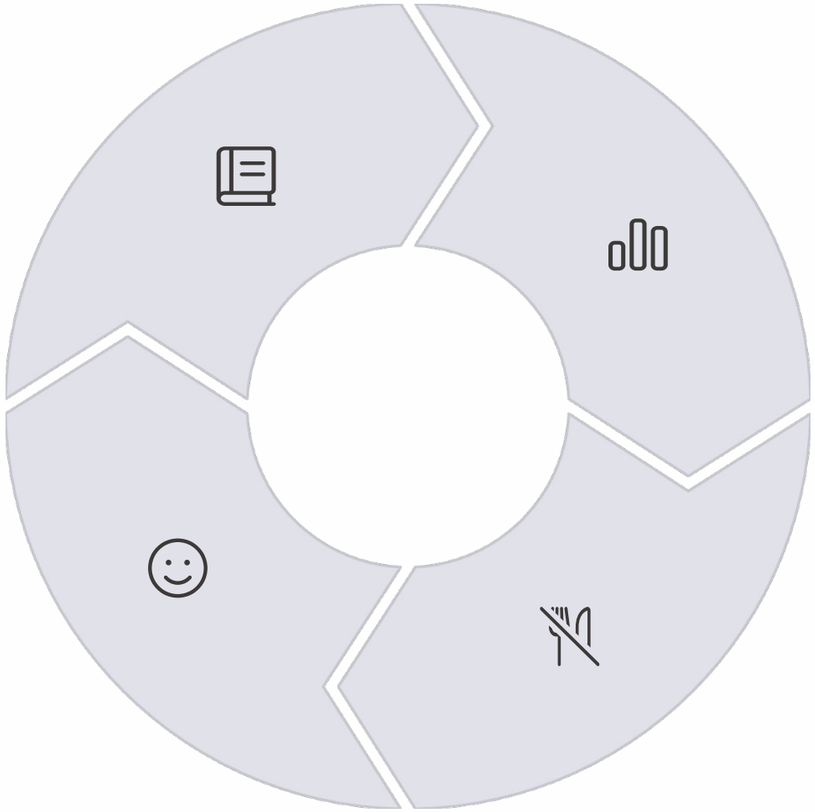
You Will Become the Expert on You

Learn

Understand the science of food and mood.

Observe

Notice your body's unique responses.



Feel Better

Experience improved mood and energy.

Adjust

Make informed choices based on your findings.

This course gives you tools to understand your body's unique responses. You are in control.

What to Remember from Today

1

Food is Brain Medicine

The connection between what you eat and how you feel is real and scientific.

2

Journey of Addition

We focus on nourishing your brain with curiosity, not restrictions.

3

You Have the Power

Small choices can lead to big shifts in mood and energy.

Your Turn: Set Your Intention

Reflect

Consider what brought you to this moment.

Connect

Link your goals to your deeper values.

Write

Document your personal "why" for this journey.

Taking a moment to define your "why" is a powerful way to start any journey.

About Autumn Persinger, PMHNP-BC

Autumn Persinger brings a wealth of diverse experience and a uniquely holistic perspective to her practice. With a nursing background spanning critical care, emergency medicine, and inpatient psychiatry, she is skilled at maintaining calm and creating safety, even in high-stress situations. Her specialized training as a sexual assault nurse examiner has deepened her trauma-informed approach, ensuring every patient feels respected and heard.

Autumn is passionate about functional psychiatry, exploring how nutritional imbalances and lifestyle habits can influence mental health. She believes in a patient-centered model where her role is to educate and guide, empowering you to make informed decisions about your well-being.

> *"Your care is in your hands. I'm here to educate, guide, and offer options—medical or holistic—that truly align with your goals."*

Clients consistently praise Autumn for her gentle, non-pushy, and nurturing approach. As one patient shared, "She provides a very safe, nurturing environment to open up and discuss whatever I felt I needed to… she never once judged me for them or made me feel uncomfortable."

For more about Autumn's background, philosophy, and the full provider team, visit:

realpsychiatricservices.com/meet-your-providers